

THE PERFORMERS

PRANAB MUKHERJEE

• Finance Minister

AGENDA The agenda in his first full term as finance minister is brimming over with plans to speed up economic growth, tackle the fiscal deficit and spur investments in areas like infrastructure. The Government also promised to roll out a roadmap of disinvestment and a Goods and Services Tax as well as expedite the passage of a number of bills. It also marked out the rationalisation of the tax regime.

PERFORMANCE The worst may be over for Asia's third largest economy, with both services and manufacturing showing an upswing. Despite a dip in farm output, the economy is set to grow at 6.3 per cent, which may pale in comparison with the 9 per cent of the past but is something that most countries would die for. He is the man for all seasons and the man for all reasons.



SIPRA DAS



P. CHIDAMBARAM



• Home Minister

AGENDA He is already on his second 100-day plan. Chidambaram took over from Shivraj Patil in the wake of the Mumbai terror attacks, promising a better security environment. He also announced operationalisation of NSG hubs at Mumbai, Chennai, Hyderabad and Kolkata and more functional powers for the National Investigative Agency (NIA). Plans are afoot to deal firmly with insurgency in the North-east and restore normalcy in Kashmir. Modernisation of police is another priority.

PERFORMANCE He has emerged as one of the best performers in terms of quick action and implementation. The NSG hubs are already operational and the ministry has also redrawn its action plan to tackle Naxalites. The issue of additional powers to the NIA is now with the Law Ministry. The ministry has been following up on action against the 26/11 accused by Pakistan, including a new dossier on Hafiz Saeed. Moreover, Chidambaram has kept up the pressure on his officials by briefing the media about the targets set and achieved by various departments.

YASBANT NEGI